

F5 Daily Briefing - Friday, August 21 - Sunday, August 23, 2026

Daily competitive intelligence covering 22 F5 competitors

22

COMPETITORS TRACKED

27

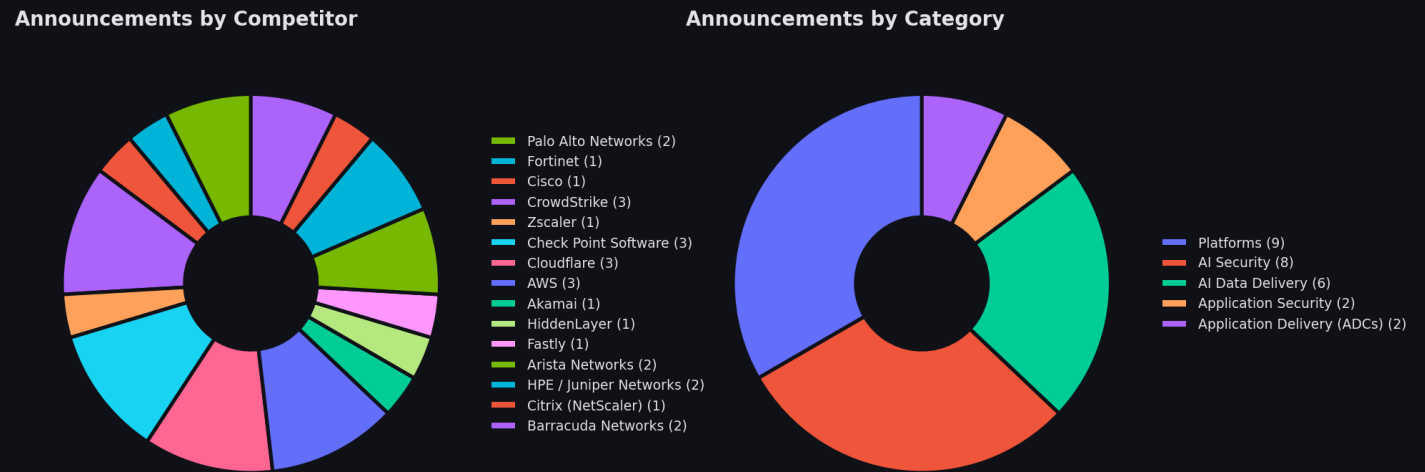
ANNOUNCEMENTS

15

ACTIVE

5

ACTIVE CATEGORIES



ALL ANNOUNCEMENTS (27)

Product Launch

Cloudflare

2026-08-23

Cloudflare Launches Bot Preference Sync and Blocks Opaque AI Crawlers

Cloudflare introduced Bot Preference Sync, which automatically generates or updates a site's robots.txt to match the AI bot policy configured in the Cloudflare dashboard, applied at the zone level across all plan tiers. Alongside it, Cloudflare published four disclosure conditions that mixed-purpose crawlers doing both search and training must meet — including respecting no-training preferences and giving site owners a control pathway — or be blocked on sites that disallow training.

<https://ppc.land/cloudflare-blocks-opaque-ai-crawlers-from-sites-that-disallow-training/>

Analyst Report

HPE / Juniper Networks

2026-08-23

Analysts See HPE's AI Infrastructure and Juniper Networking as Next Growth Phase

A weekend analyst note argued that AI infrastructure demand plus the Juniper acquisition position HPE for a new growth phase. Q2 FY2026 revenue reached \$10.7 billion, up 40% year over year, with Cloud and AI revenue up 22.9% and Networking revenue up 148.2% on the Juniper contribution. Non-GAAP EPS rose 108% year over year, cloud and AI operating margin nearly doubled, and free cash flow guidance was raised to at least \$3.5 billion.

<https://seekingalpha.com/article/4939392-hewlett-packard-enterprise-ai-infrastructure-and-juniper-could-unlock-the-next-growth-phase>

Partnership

Barracuda Networks

2026-08-23

Barracuda Crowns Top A/NZ Partners for 2026 at Melbourne Partner Summit

Barracuda announced its 2026 A/NZ Partner Awards at the Barracuda A/NZ Partner Summit in Melbourne, recognizing partners for growth, customer outcomes and alignment with its BarracudaONE platform strategy. Winners included Winthrop Australia (Partner of the Year), Alliance Business Technologies (MSP Partner of the Year), Synnex Australia (Distributor of the Year), Datacom (Email Security) and NetStrategy (XDR/Managed Security Services). Country manager Dan McLean highlighted continued investment in the local channel and partner-led cyber resilience.

<https://www.arnnet.com.au/article/4212710/barracuda-networks-crowns-top-a-nz-partners-for-2026.html>

Partnership

CrowdStrike

2026-08-22

CrowdStrike Signs Distribution Agreement with Arrow Electronics for North America

CrowdStrike signed a distribution agreement with Arrow Electronics to bring the Falcon platform to Arrow's U.S. and Canada channel partners. Resellers, CSPs, MSPs and MSSPs can procure and deploy Falcon Next-Gen SIEM, Falcon Cloud Security and the broader platform through ArrowSphere with flexible billing. Both companies pitched the deal as a way for mid-market and enterprise customers to consolidate fragmented security tooling onto a single platform while controlling cost.

<https://www.contenttechseries.com/news/crowdstrike-signs-distribution-agreement-with-arrow-electronics-to-accelerate-cybersecurity-transformation-across-north-america>

Partnership

CrowdStrike

2026-08-22

CrowdStrike Mobilizes Partner Coalition to Extend Project QuiltWorks to SMB and Midmarket

CrowdStrike widened its Project QuiltWorks coalition beyond large enterprises to midmarket and SMB customers, recruiting distributors and MSPs including Arrow Electronics, Pax8 and TD Synnex. The program pairs the Falcon platform with partner services to assess security posture, prioritize vulnerabilities and deliver ongoing remediation and managed services for organizations without dedicated security staff. It extends CrowdStrike's frontier AI risk messaging into a channel-led motion aimed at a segment F5 also reaches through partners.

<https://www.channeldive.com/news/crowdstrike-project-quiltworks-midmarket-cybersecurity-partners/828400/>

Executive Move

CrowdStrike

2026-08-22

CrowdStrike CTO Departure Raises Questions About Its AI Security Ambitions

Analyst commentary examined CrowdStrike's stock reaction to its CTO leaving to launch an AI fund, weighing whether the exit complicates the company's AI security roadmap. The piece notes CrowdStrike has been building AI detection and response, agentic MDR and frontier AI risk programs as core growth drivers, making technical leadership continuity material to that narrative ahead of Fal.Con 2026. Competitors positioning against CrowdStrike on AI security have an opening to raise execution risk.

<https://simplywall.st/stocks/us/software/nasdaq-crowd/crowdstrike-holdings/news/does-crowdstrike-crowd-losing-its-cto-complicate-the-story-of>

Research

Check Point Software

2026-08-22

Check Point Argues AI Is Collapsing the Window Defenders Have to React

Glen Deskin, Head of Engineering at Check Point, argued in a Federal News Network segment that AI-driven attack and defense now operate at machine speed, making AI adoption in security non-optional. He outlined a maturity path from AI-assisted analysis, to AI-assisted decision-making, to autonomous or human-on-the-loop response with safeguards. Key priorities for agencies and enterprises include gaining full visibility into the AI tools in use and shortening detection-to-containment time.

<https://federalnewsnetwork.com/cybersecurity/2026/08/what-happens-when-ai-shrinks-the-window-cyber-defender-have-to-react/>

Product Update

Cloudflare

2026-08-22

Cloudflare Adds Optional OAuth Scopes and Least-Privilege Consent for Wrangler and MCP Server

Cloudflare shifted OAuth consent from all-or-nothing to a task-based, least-privilege model, rolling the change out to the Wrangler CLI and the Cloudflare API MCP server. Users can search available permissions, pick Read Only or Full Access templates, and disable optional scopes before granting consent, while required scopes remain mandatory. The update targets terminal and AI-assisted workflows where agents request broad API access by default.

<https://linklout.io/blog/cloudflare-wrangler-mcp-optional-oauth-scopes>

Product Launch**Cloudflare****2026-08-22**

Cloudflare Announces Kitesurf, a Rust-Based Browser Engine Built for AI Agents

Cloudflare unveiled Kitesurf, a lightweight browser-like engine for automated workloads and AI agents that runs browser components in isolated WebAssembly/Rust environments on Cloudflare Workers. It supports the Chrome DevTools Protocol so Playwright and Puppeteer work against it, using far less CPU and memory than full Chromium for tasks such as screenshots and HTML extraction. Cloudflare positions it as a low-fidelity, highly scalable engine rather than a Chromium replacement.

<https://www.infoq.com/news/2026/08/cloudflare-kitesurf-browser/>

Threat Intel**AWS****2026-08-22**

AWS Strands Agents Tools Hit With Four CVEs in 23 Days, All From the Same Root Cause

Four first-party security advisories for AWS Strands Agents Tools, part of the Strands Agents SDK, all traced to a single root cause: security-sensitive parameters such as endpoint URLs, cloud IDs and API keys were exposed as LLM-controllable inputs in tool schemas. That design allowed prompt injection to redirect calls or misuse credentials, including falling back to environment variables when keys were omitted. The pattern highlights systemic agentic-AI tool-schema risk in vendor SDKs.

<https://forkast.news/aws-strands-agents-tools-received-four-cves-in-23-days-and-they-all-share-the-same-root-cause/>

Analyst Report**Arista Networks****2026-08-22**

Arista Positioned as Key Hyperscale AI Data Center Supplier in Weekend Analyst Coverage

Analyst coverage published over the weekend framed Arista as a core beneficiary of hyperscale AI, ML and cloud infrastructure buildouts, citing its high-performance switching and routing platforms. The piece argues the migration to open Ethernet for AI fabrics materially expands Arista's addressable market and earnings power, while flagging customer concentration and competition from Cisco and NVIDIA as the primary risks. It points to AI-focused product wins and guidance updates at upcoming industry events as key indicators.

<https://au.finance.yahoo.com/news/arista-networks-anet-key-player-001542007.html>

Partnership**Palo Alto Networks****2026-08-21**

NTT DATA and Palo Alto Networks Expand AI Security Alliance Targeting \$1B in Joint Business

Palo Alto Networks and NTT DATA expanded a multi-year global strategic alliance aimed at securely accelerating enterprise AI adoption and cybersecurity modernization, targeting up to \$1 billion in joint business by 2029. The partnership pairs Palo Alto's AI-powered platforms and Unit 42 threat intelligence with NTT DATA's consulting, engineering and managed services, including Frontier AI governance. Delivery spans 2,000+ certified experts, joint engineering and dedicated forward-deployed engineers.

<https://www.channelinsider.com/security/ntt-data-palo-alto-networks-ai/>

Product Launch**Palo Alto Networks****2026-08-21**

Unit 42 Expands Frontier AI Defense with Anthropic's Claude Mythos 5

Palo Alto Networks' Unit 42 expanded its Frontier AI Defense offering using Anthropic's Claude Mythos 5, pairing frontier models with threat intelligence to discover exposures, test exploitability, map attack paths and prioritize remediation. The service uses a multi-model harness, exposure discovery across apps and networks, adversary simulation and custom remediation plans wired into existing workflows. Unit 42 human experts validate model output so findings arrive as prioritized, actionable defenses rather than raw vulnerability lists.

<https://www.paloaltonetworks.com/blog/2026/08/unit-42-defends-organizations-against-next-gen-frontier-ai-risks-with-anthropics-mythos-5/>

Research**Fortinet****2026-08-21**

Fortinet 2026 Report Highlights Growing AI Security Gap

Fortinet published research showing enterprise AI adoption is outpacing the security controls organizations have in place, leaving a widening gap between deployed AI systems and the guardrails protecting them. The report frames AI runtime protection, model validation and governance of autonomous agents as the fastest-emerging enterprise requirement, and positions Fortinet's Security Fabric and AI-focused portfolio as the consolidation answer. It is the data point Fortinet is using to justify its recent AI security expansion.

<https://securitynews.com/security/fortinet-2026-report-highlights-growing-ai-security-gap/>

Threat Intel

Cisco

2026-08-21

Cisco Discloses Critical Crosswork and Secure Workload Flaws, Including Two CVSS 10.0 Bugs

Cisco disclosed nine vulnerabilities across Crosswork and Secure Workload, including CVE-2026-20315 and CVE-2026-20317 rated a perfect 10.0 for authorization and authentication bypass, plus a 9.9 injection flaw and a 9.6 input-validation flaw. SaaS instances are fixed by Cisco; on-premises customers must upgrade agents and connectors to 3.10.9.1 or 4.0.4.16 and later. Cisco said the issues were found through internal AI-assisted security testing, with no evidence of exploitation to date.

<https://www.theregister.com/security/2026/08/21/cisco-bug-severity-warning-reads-like-olympic-gymnastics-scores-10-10-99-96-and-75/5290838>

Research

Zscaler

2026-08-21

Zscaler: How to Close the AI Security Gap Across the Full AI Lifecycle

Zscaler argued that AI governance is lagging adoption, citing 3,400+ AI/ML apps driving transactions and 93% growth in AI data transfer. In assessments of 38 large enterprises, none had fully secured their AI tools from external attack and many AI systems were publicly reachable without controls. Zscaler pitched a three-part Zero Trust answer: AI Asset Management to discover the AI footprint, AI Access Security for conditional access, and AI Guardrails plus AI Red Teaming for runtime protection.

<https://www.zscaler.com/blogs/cxo-insights/how-to-close-the-ai-security-gap>

Partnership

Check Point Software

2026-08-21

Check Point CEO and India's Piyush Goyal Discuss AI-Driven Security for Digital Public Infrastructure

Check Point's CEO met India's Commerce and Industry Minister Piyush Goyal in Singapore to discuss expanding Check Point's R&D footprint in India and deploying AI-driven security to protect the country's digital public infrastructure. Talks covered broader cooperation on cybersecurity, digital trust and AI-led innovation supporting India's tech-driven growth. The engagement signals Check Point's push to tie its platform strategy to national-scale digital infrastructure programs in high-growth markets.

<https://www.newkerala.com/news/a/piyush-goyal-check-point-ceo-discuss-cybersecurity-ai-driven-296.htm>

Research

Check Point Software

2026-08-21

Check Point CISO: AI Adoption Pushes Security Leaders Closer to Business Decisions

Check Point Global CISO Jonathan Fischbein argued that embedding AI models and applications across the enterprise is reshaping the CISO role, pushing security leaders to act as business facilitators rather than pure technical gatekeepers. The piece highlights rising data protection, governance and control concerns as AI spreads, and notes AI is simultaneously accelerating threat discovery and vulnerability management while raising expectations for fast, secure delivery alongside Zero Trust and resilience practices.

<https://tiinside.com.br/en/21/08/2026/ia-amplia-pressao-sobre-cisos-e-aproxima-seguranca-das-decisoes-de-negocio/>

Product Launch

AWS

2026-08-21

Amazon Connect Adds Conversational AI Analytics for Contact Center Managers

AWS launched conversational data insights in Amazon Connect, letting managers ask plain-language questions and get answers, supporting evidence and suggested fixes drawn from over 150 self-service, agent performance and queue metrics. The system explains drivers, produces prioritized action plans with confidence scores and projected impact, and supports drilling from broad to specific topics within a single conversation — for example, pinpointing queues where handle time and after-contact work justify automation.

<https://aws.amazon.com/about-aws/whats-new/2026/08/amazon-connect-customer-ai-data-analytics/>

Product Update

AWS

2026-08-21

AWS Glue 6.0 Reaches GA With 30% Price Cut and Full Apache Iceberg v3 Support

AWS made Glue 6.0 generally available with a 30% price reduction versus prior versions and full Apache Iceberg v3 support, plus newer Hudi and Delta Lake releases. The runtime moves to Apache Spark 4.1, Python 3.13 and Scala 2.13, and adds Spark Declarative Pipelines, a Real-Time Mode for sub-second streaming and Arrow-native Python UDFs. Iceberg v3 brings VARIANT types with automatic shredding, deletion vectors and geospatial types. Available across Commercial, GovCloud and China regions.

<https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/aws/aws-glue-6-0-now-available-with-30-lower-price-and-full-apache-iceberg-v3-support/>

Product Update**Akamai****2026-08-21**

Akamai Pushes Real-Time Observability and New AI-Risk Security Strategies in Latin America

Akamai highlighted Cloud Pulse Alerts for real-time infrastructure observability and argued enterprises need new cybersecurity strategies to handle AI-driven risk. Fernando Serto, Akamai's CTO for Latin America, stressed that comprehensive visibility is required to detect and diagnose issues affecting digital experiences quickly. The company also outlined continued 2026 Latin America investment, including global R&D work plus local expansion of talent and go-to-market coverage.

<https://mexicobusiness.news/cybersecurity/news/new-cybersecurity-strategies-needed-handle-ai-risks>

Partnership**HiddenLayer****2026-08-21**

HiddenLayer in Prometheus: AI Security for Nuclear Infrastructure

Coverage of HiddenLayer's role in the U.S. Department of Energy's Prometheus initiative, a \$60 million Phase II program under the Genesis Mission uniting national labs, academia and 20+ industry partners. HiddenLayer supplies AI security expertise across the full lifecycle — data supply chain, development, deployment and runtime — for AI used in nuclear energy and critical infrastructure. The analysis highlights prompt injection, data contamination, model and dependency supply chain risk, and governance gaps in regulated environments.

<https://nhimg.org/articles/hiddenlayer-in-prometheus-ai-security-for-nuclear-infrastructure/>

Product Update**Fastly****2026-08-21**

Fastly Expands India Network to 60+ PoPs and 28 Tbps as AI Traffic Surges

Fastly detailed a major India expansion, growing to 60+ PoPs and roughly 28 Tbps of capacity from about 2.2 Tbps in early 2025, alongside local sales, support, engineering and a Pune center of excellence. Executives cited AI traffic growing about 30% from January to May 2026, roughly 6.5x faster than human traffic, with over 51% of AI requests reaching origin versus under 9% for human requests. Fastly positions the edge as a control layer for AI routing, security and origin cost reduction.

<https://www.dqindia.com/news/fastly-expands-india-focus-as-ai-traffic-grows-12407671>

Analyst Report**Arista Networks****2026-08-21**

Arista Says AI Demand Is Broadening as Supply Constraints Cap Upside to 40% Growth Guide

Arista reiterated a roughly 40% revenue growth guide, saying AI networking demand is now broad-based across hyperscalers, neoclouds, AI labs, enterprises and campus buyers rather than concentrated in a few accounts. Its Etherlink AI portfolio has expanded from four or five customers in 2024 to more than 100. Component supply remains the limiting factor on upside, with price increases planned to protect 62-64% gross margins. Arista also flagged ESAN scale-up standardization work in OCP and 1.6T air- and liquid-cooled trials.

<https://www.dailypolitical.com/2026/08/21/arista-networks-says-ai-demand-broadens-as-supply-limits-upside-to-40-growth-guide.html>

Product Update**HPE / Juniper Networks****2026-08-21**

University of Leeds Deploys HPE Juniper Self-Driving Network for AI-Native Campus

The University of Leeds selected HPE's Self-Driving Network to modernize campus-wide wired and wireless infrastructure for students, staff and researchers. The deployment is built on the HPE Mist platform and combines HPE EX switches, HPE Juniper QFX switches, Mist access points, Marvis AIOps and Wi-Fi 7. HPE positions the win around end-to-end observability, automated network management and a unified agentic AIOps experience that self-optimizes to resolve issues proactively for research and teaching workloads.

<https://www.techfinitive.com/university-of-leeds-taps-hpe-for-ai-native-campus-network/>

Threat Intel**Citrix (NetScaler)****2026-08-21**

Citrix Urges Customers to Patch Critical NetScaler Authentication Bypass (CVE-2026-19490)

Citrix is pressing customers to immediately patch CVE-2026-19490, a CVSS 9.3 authentication bypass in NetScaler ADC and NetScaler Gateway that lets unauthenticated attackers reach Gateway (SSL VPN, ICA Proxy, CVPN, RDP Proxy) and AAA virtual servers via an alternate path. A companion memory-overflow flaw, CVE-2026-19489, can cause denial of service where SIP ALG is enabled. Fixes land in 14.1-73.32, 13.1-63.21 and the FIPS/NDcPP equivalents; researchers expect exploitation attempts against these internet-facing appliances.

<https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/08/21/citrix-netscaler-gateway-cve-2026-19490/>

Threat Intel

Barracuda Networks

2026-08-21

Barracuda: 24 Billion Stolen Credentials Make the Browser Cybercrime's Favorite Endpoint

Barracuda published research arguing the browser has become the primary entry point for attackers, citing roughly 24 billion stolen credentials in circulation. Infostealers now harvest complete digital identities — saved passwords, session cookies, OAuth tokens and cloud credentials — through fake updates, malicious extensions, cracked apps and AI-themed lures. Barracuda recommends treating the browser as a security boundary and layering identity protection, phishing defense, session security and continuous monitoring backed by Managed XDR.

<https://blog.barracuda.com/2026/08/21/stolen-credentials-browser-is-cybercrime-endpoint>